

Some popular agentic AI frameworks

- Microsoft AutoGen
- LangChain
- LangGraph
- CrewAI
- OpenAI Swarm
- MetaGPT
- LlamaIndex
- Botpress

worthy investment in many organisations—a calm yet high-performing employee, to say the least. According to a recent report by the Boston Consulting Group, people must get used to working closely with AI agents as teammates. “AI agents will be onboarded, just like human workers, to learn roles and responsibilities, access relevant company data and business context, integrate into workflows, and support the humans’ responsibilities,” it says.

In a recent media interview, Stuart Brown, head of digital business at Guidehouse, a PwC spin-off that consults for commercial businesses and governments, said, “Many people don’t understand the impact... Some still think it’s just another tool. But agentic AI will bring a fundamental change in how we operate. It will create new ways of working.”

Indeed, many companies have already deployed AI agents for various tasks, and many are taking the leap. But, take it all with a pinch of salt. AI experts and business leaders warn that while agentic AI has great potential to transform businesses, it is not a silver bullet for all enterprise needs. Like all technologies that leapfrogged to the mainstream, AI has its share of problems, all of which trickle down to agentic AI.

We read about AI hallucinations in the February 2025 issue of

Electronics For You. AI agents are known to have fabricated non-existent clients, bank transactions, legal precedents and company policies, and companies that did not have proper guardrails in place have had to face the music. When a legal team presented fictitious case precedents doled out by an AI chatbot, they had to contend with public disapproval, on top of hefty fines slapped on them by the court.

In another incident, Air Canada had to partially compensate a customer who was misguided by an AI agent, which erroneously cooked up some bereavement travel policies! Hallucinations and misinformation are a serious issue that the industry needs to tackle, because they not only inconvenience users but also lead to ethical concerns.

Since agentic AI permeates quite deeply into a company’s operational fabric, data security and privacy are also serious concerns. Just imagine the amount of enterprise data—including that of third parties like customers and vendors—that AI agents access, and evaluate what happens if security is compromised and someone uses that information maliciously.

Indeed, AI hallucinations, data security and privacy issues, and ethical concerns, particularly about misinformation, are some of the issues that need to be solved methodically by the AI industry on an urgent basis. Till then, AI agents will have to be deployed with human oversight and proper control points. If companies take the leap without first implementing proper guardrails, they will have to face the music. However, if employed properly and to the right extent, agentic AI can be a wonderful addition to your team. As in everything, you just need to strike the right balance. **EFY**


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IS THERE A SOLDERING STATION WITH TRACEABILITY?

INTRODUCING i-CON TRACE IOT SOLDERING STATION



With the i-con TRACE, ERSA is introducing the first soldering station specifically designed for use in a digitally networked environment, ensuring complete traceability in hand soldering. This station features WLAN Bluetooth, and an upgradeable network card, providing enhanced connectivity.

Traceability

Specific soldering tasks can be centrally assigned to each soldering station via a Manufacturing Execution System (MES), a PC, or a mobile device. All essential parameters, such as the soldering tip to be used, temperature, soldering wire, and flux, are set centrally by qualified personnel. This significantly increases process reliability. Each workpiece is soldered according to predefined specifications, allowing the operator to fully concentrate on the soldering task and reducing the likelihood of errors.




USABILITY

With only one on/off switch and three LEDs, the interface of the soldering station differs significantly from all other industrial soldering stations with their complex setting options and a display. The work for the personnel at the soldering station is significantly simplified. By means of a hand-held scanner the component, soldering tip, solder wire and flux used are recorded. In this way, the system knows that all the conditions for the assigned soldering task are met. The LED interface then literally gives the user the green light as soon as the predefined temperature is reached at the soldering tip. An effective measure to ensure that each solder joint is soldered with the exact temperature and the right material. Any malfunctions (eg. defective heating element, wrong soldering tip in relation to the component) are detected by the system and reported to the operator. If all parameters are correct, the soldering process is authorized. During soldering, the i-CON TRACE records the process data. Every soldering process is precisely documented and traceable.



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